Open Source 101 with Angular

How I started contributing to enterprise open source, and how you can do it too.



github.com/erkamyaman

Hi, I'm erKam



`{{ erKam | kæm }}` Döner kebab in developer form 🌯

- Working at **Kolay Randevu / SalonAppy**
- Building **slide.ng**, slides for Angular
- Contributing to **Angular**, docs and docs-infra
- Building **Pangular Inspector**, with Santosh Yadav
- Contributing to **Angular Native**

Today

5

First contribution

1

How I started

2

What to send or skip

3

Where to find things to fix

4

PRs to big projects

My first PR

A Turkish translation of the Angular docs



Made for Turkish developers

It showed me the process works

Next

The first review, and when I realized I could keep doing this

The first review

Before

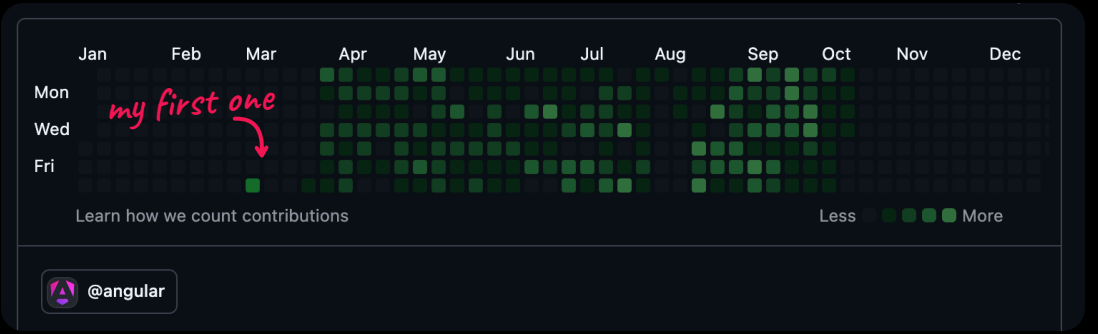
What I felt before clicking “Create pull request”

The wait

How long it took and what the review looked like

After

The moment I thought “I can keep doing this”



What happened next

241 merged PRs

in `angular/angular`

What happened next

My best work is in docs-infra

Plus docs and small fixes across the framework

What happened next

An Angular team member reached out



Matthieu Riegler challenged me to bring Angie, the Angular mascot, into angular.dev

Angie is everywhere



Angie, the Angular mascot

15+
small PRs

`angular.dev`

Not found page, error states, cookie popup, minigame, tutorials

`Illustrations`

Roadmap, routing, globe, components, guide headers

`DevTools`

Empty states



If you see Angie in a random place on angular.dev, that was probably me

What happened next

Building with Santosh Yadav

Angular GDE and GitHub Star.

Together:  **Pangular Inspector**

What happened next

And more

Angular Native, the great work of Ashley Hunter

What gets merged

241 PRs, 252 commits so far

What I like to send

- Doc fixes 127
- docs-infra bug fixes 64
- Code examples and tutorials 56
- Broken links and anchors 36
- Angie illustrations 17
- docs-infra features 11
- DevTools 8
- Compiler and language tooling 6

What I prefer to skip

- Typos and formatting
- == to ===
- Unused imports
- New docs pages
- Accessibility-only fixes
- Roadmap updates

My workflow

One focused day

Mostly Sundays

I lock in to hunt for issues

With AI

Claude Code

finds bugs, drafts fixes, writes tests

Same bug, other places

Same pattern

if a bug happened once, it is elsewhere too

I treat AI output like a PR from a stranger: I read all of it and reproduce each bug before and after the fix.

Most findings are false positives. The survivors get ranked, and I read every PR locally before I send it.

Angular ships skills for your agent

`adev-writing-guide`

How docs must be written

Google writing rules and Angular markdown

`pr_review`

How a PR gets reviewed

Read all of it, check the commit message

`AGENTS.md`

What an agent may do here

pnpm, Bazel tests, zoneless test style

`angular-developer`

For app developers

best practices for signals, forms, HTTP

☆ The same rules a human follows, written for the agent

Where the bugs come from

Hunting day

Open issues, then the code

I read issues, then the code behind them: angular.dev, packages and the router

My day job

Hit a bug, open a PR

Building real apps at work, I run into framework bugs and send the fix upstream

Poking around

Browse angular.dev by hand

UI and UX bugs I can see in the browser myself

While working

The docs let me down

a broken link, a wrong example or a missing piece

Sending a PR to enterprise open source

Before

Sign the CLA

once, with your commit email

Checks

CI must pass

and the commit message lint

Review

Owners approve

who own that part of the code

Time

Reviews take days

be patient with the team

So

Follow every rule

a proven PR passes

Be a good citizen

Reviews

Don't ping for a review

the team gets to it in their own time

Open PRs

Max 10 open PRs

a GitHub Action blocks you from opening more

AI

No AI spam

read it yourself first

Duplicates

Search first

for an open issue or PR on the same problem

Be a better citizen

AI

Don't go for glory with AI

Some people let AI write their PRs and send low-quality work that only looks shiny. Do what you know. Send only what you can stand behind.

Prove it before you open it (be the best citizen)

Step 1

Reproduce

the claim with a command

Step 2

Check the page

the rendered page, not just the markup

Step 3

Write the PR

with the proof inside

> ☆ A PR with proof gets reviewed. A PR with an opinion gets questions. Reviewers have little time, and evidence saves it.

Preparing the PR

Branch

Start from main

one fix per branch

Change

Keep it small

only the lines the fix needs

Test

Run the tests you need

only for your change

Review

Read your diff

like a PR from a stranger

Commit

Follow the guidelines

type, scope, short header

Description

What, why, proof

like #68625: the bug, before and after screenshots

Commit messages matter

```
fix(docs-infra): correct the quoted error message

Update the quoted error to match what the compiler prints.
```

`fix`

Type

fix, feat, docs and more

`docs-infra`

Scope

the package, like core

Summary

short, lowercase, no period

Body

say why, 20 characters or more

☆ Angular's rules: commit-message-guidelines.md

The PR description

```
## PR Type
Bugfix, angular.dev application / infrastructure changes

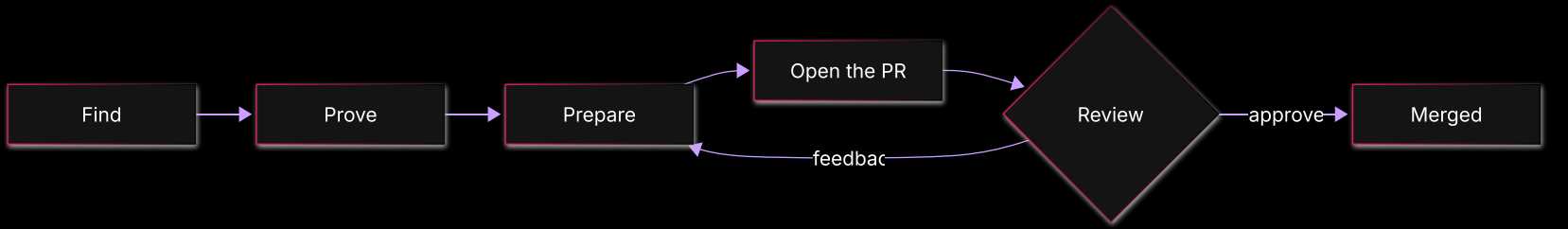
## What is the current behavior?
The version picker dropdown cannot scroll to the last version.

## What is the new behavior?
The dropdown scrolls to the last version on every screen size.

## Does this PR introduce a breaking change?
No
```

☆ Fill every section. Real example: #68625

The whole loop



Your first contribution

- Pick a project you already use
- Read the contributing guide
- Find a factual error in the docs and prove it
- Open a small PR
- Be patient. Reviews might take days
- Expect feedback. It is not rejection

Bonus: use my first-time contribution skill

Find

Spot the problem

something wrong or broken in the docs

Prove

Reproduce first

see the bug yourself, on the real page

Prepare

Prepare the PR

branch, commit and PR text

Version 1

Angular version

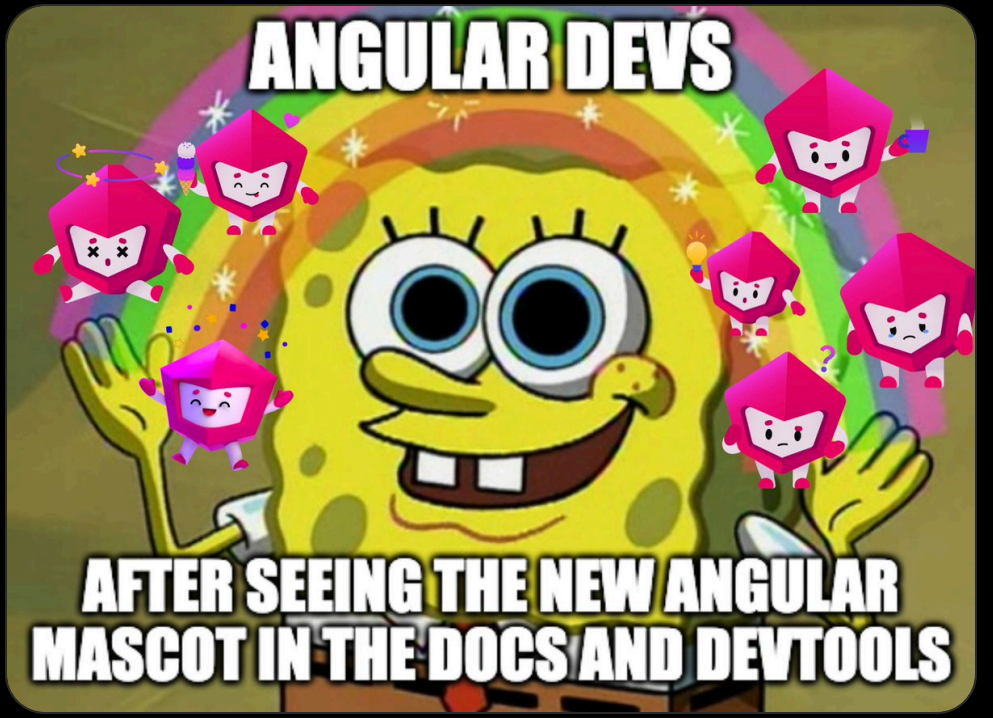
Angular's commit and docs rules

Version 2

Unified version

follows any project's guide

Questions?


ANGULAR DEVS
AFTER SEEING THE NEW ANGULAR MASCOT IN THE DOCS AND DEVTOOLS

Thank you

github.com/erkamyaman

x.com/erkamyaman_ng

linkedin.com/in/erkamyaman

Scan for my links



Made with slide.ng

Markdown slides with Angular templates



github.com/slide-ng/slide.ng